



Rowan Pike

FINANCE LEAD · EVERGREEN & PINE CO.

“Every number in its place. Every receipt accounted for.”



FOR ROWAN PIKE’S EYES ONLY

Do not show these pages to anyone, including the host.

WHO YOU ARE (EVERYONE KNOWS THIS)

You are the Finance Lead of Evergreen & Pine Co. You look after budgets, supplier payments and the company cards. Seven years in, you are known for staying calm when everyone else panics about numbers.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Bart Pringle:** went through the year-end budget with you this month.
- **Walt Evergreen:** hired you seven years ago.
- **Remy Fox:** your Finance Clerk, and the best receipt-sorter in the building.



YOUR PARTY ACCESSORY

A cranberry-and-silver plaid scarf. No full costume needed.

HOW THIS BOOKLET WORKS

1. Before the party, read pages 1 and 2 alone.
2. Page 3 holds Rounds 1 and 2. Fold it so only Round 1 shows; open Round 2 only when called.
3. Page 4 is Round 3 and your notes: keep it shut until Round 3.
4. You may help a team, but never vote for yourself.

THE CASE (EVERYONE KNOWS THIS)

At 4:15 pm Bart Pringle, VP of Sales, opened a Secret Santa gift: a tin of peppermint fudge. About twenty minutes later Bart collapsed. Every gift had waited on the side-hallway table, and ten people are suspects.

YOUR EVENING AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive wearing your accessory and name tag.
2. Detective Holloway reads Script 1.
3. Three Rounds: reveal, ask, mission.
4. Ballots, then the big reveal.

PAGE 1	PAGE 2	PAGE 3 · ROUND 1	PAGE 3 · ROUND 2	PAGE 4 · ROUND 3
Who you are Public facts	Your secret Story & goal	Tonight	New twists	Final answers + Notes



You are the culprit. Only you know this. Your cover story is below.



Your private background

KEEP IT QUIET

YOUR STORY

You joined seven years ago, when Evergreen & Pine was half its size. You built the budget system, set up every supplier account and hold the Finance company card. December is your busiest month: you have stayed late almost every night closing out the year.

YOUR SECRET: DO NOT REVEAL IT UNTIL A ROUND TELLS YOU TO

Two years ago money got tight at home, and you set up "Northstar Ribbon Supply," a supplier that exists only as a P.O. box you control. You approved 14 invoices for ribbon that never arrived. You always meant to pay it back.

WHAT HAPPENED ON THURSDAY

On Thursday, the day before the party, Bart called you in: checking the budget, Bart had found the Northstar invoices. "Enjoy the party, Rowan. Monday at nine, you and I are seeing Uncle Walt." That evening you bought a tin of peppermint fudge at Maple Street Bakery (out of habit, you paid with the Finance card) and tampered with it. Back at the office you printed a gold-foil tag on the shared label printer, "To: Bart. From: Your Secret Santa," and wrapped the tin in a midnight-blue box.

WHAT YOU DID TODAY

Today at 3:30 pm you dialed the bank's budget line, hung up a minute later, switched off your light and locked your door. At about 3:40, during the toast, you slipped into the dim side hallway, swapped Bart's green box for yours and pushed the green box behind the coat rack. You were back in the main hall by 3:52.

YOUR COVER STORY

"I was on the year-end budget call in the Finance office from 3:30 until about 3:55, with the light off because of a headache."

HOW TO WIN

Stay calm and keep suspicion on others. You may lie, but never deny what an evidence card plainly shows: explain it away instead. You win if fewer than half of the teams name you.

GUESTS MAY ASK YOU

- **G3: "Where were you between 3:30 and 4:00 pm?"** Give your cover story: "On the budget call in my office, light off for a headache."
- **G16: "Why has the shredder been so busy?"** "Year-end cleanup. Seven years of old receipts."
- **G20: "Did you see anyone in the side hallway this afternoon?"** "No. I never went near the side hallway."

How to play this booklet: open each Round (page 3: Rounds 1–2, page 4: Round 3) only when Detective Holloway calls it.

Rounds 1 & 2

ROWAN PIKE • OPEN ONLY WHEN CALLED

❄ Round 1



Read only when Detective Holloway starts Round 1

REVEAL

- Share your cover story: you were on the year-end budget call in the Finance office from 3:30 to about 3:55 pm.
- You heard Kendall Brooks arguing with Bart near the sales desks around 3:20 pm. (This is true.)
- Bart had a famous sweet tooth: "Anyone who knew Bart knew a box of sweets would get opened first."

ASK

Ask **Kendall Brooks**: "What were you and Bart arguing about?"

MISSION

Compliment three people on their party accessories, and quietly remember who wears what.

IF ACCUSED

"I was on a call in my office. It's right there on the shared calendar."

✂ **Fold here.** Keep Round 2 folded under until Detective Holloway calls **Round 2**.

❄ Round 2



Read only when Detective Holloway starts Round 2

REVEAL

- About the toast photo: "Of course I'm not in it. I was on my call."
- About the bakery receipt: "Lots of people buy gifts on company cards in December. And Finley keeps spare keys to every desk drawer."
- Steer attention to Jesse Marlow, who carried peppermint fudge around all morning for a photo shoot.

ASK

Ask **Jesse Marlow**: "Where did your photo-shoot fudge end up?"

MISSION

Join a team's huddle and suggest a different suspect, without saying anything a card could disprove.

IF ACCUSED

"If I wanted to hide a purchase, would I really use my own department's card?"

NOTES: WHO SAID WHAT?

Round 3

ROWAN PIKE • OPEN ONLY WHEN CALLED

 **Stop.** Keep this page folded shut until Detective Holloway calls **Round 3**.

Round 3



Read only when Detective Holloway starts Round 3

REVEAL

- About the phone log: “The call dropped. I sat in the dark waiting for them to ring back.”
- About Northstar Ribbon Supply: admit only “a paperwork mix-up with a supplier” that you and Bart were going to sort out on Monday.
- Suggest that the “R.” on Bart’s note could mean Reese Whitfield. (If Reese isn’t playing, remind everyone how angry Kendall was.)

ASK

Ask **Emerson Gray**: "Was HR looking into Bart's expenses?"

MISSION

Stay calm to the end. If a team asks for your final word, say: "Follow the money, but follow it correctly."

IF ACCUSED

"A mix-up with an invoice is no reason to hurt anyone. You're reaching."

Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

SUSPECT QUICK LIST (PUBLIC)

NAME	ROLE	NAME	ROLE
Avery Quill	Office Manager	Emerson Gray	HR Director
Rowan Pike	Finance Lead	Skyler Moss	Intern
Jesse Marlow	Marketing Lead	Drew Calder	Caterer
Kendall Brooks	Top Sales Rep	Reese Whitfield	Rival Company Rep
Parker Lane	IT Support	Finley Dale	Founder's Assistant